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EXCEL

— EXCELLENCE —

25 Must-Know Interview Questions

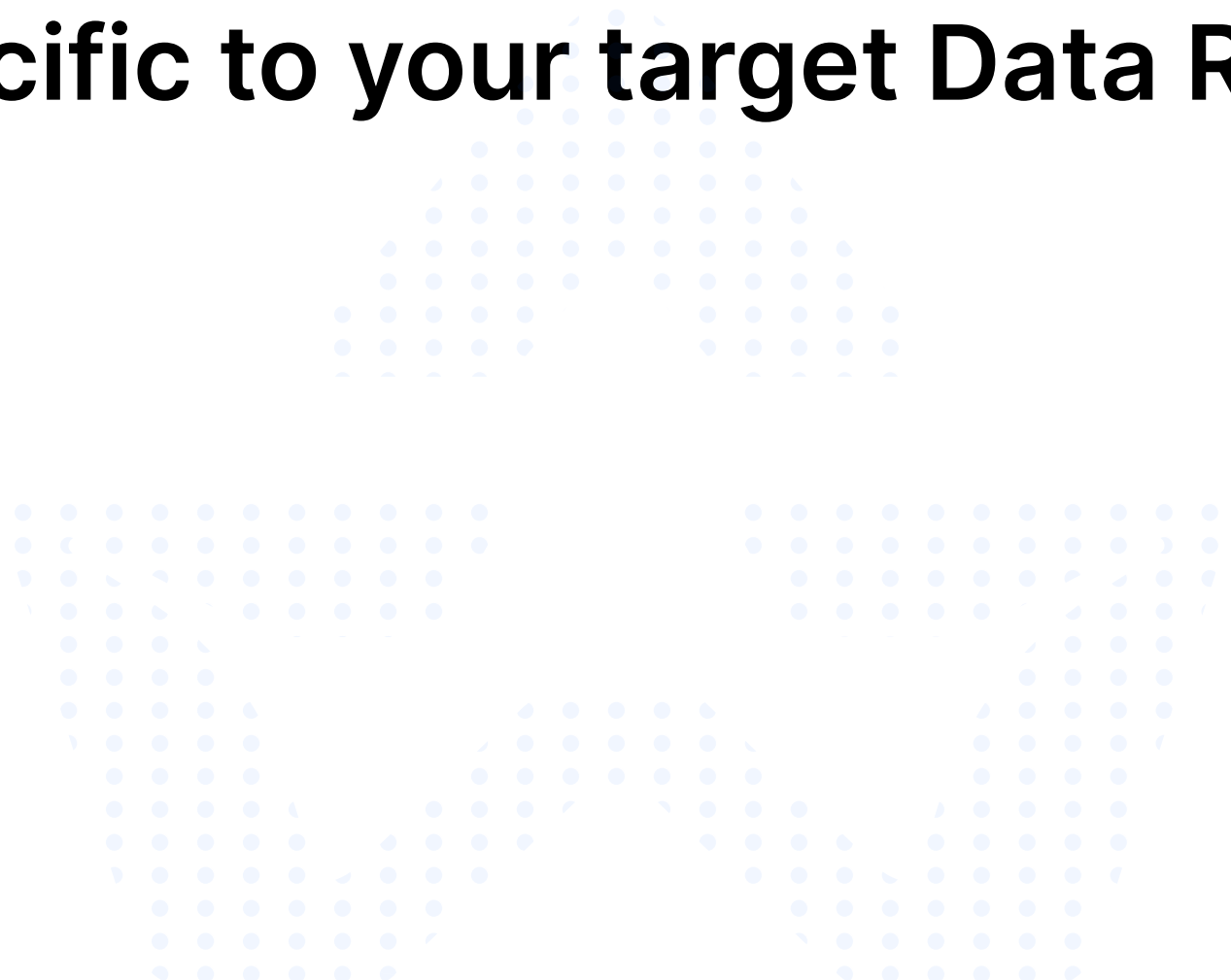


Bonus Data-Specific Questions



To excel as a Data Analyst or Scientist, mastering specific Excel functions and features is crucial. So, here's an outline of the most asked Excel interview questions that you should be familiar with.

Stay till the end, to get bonus questions specific to your target Data Role!

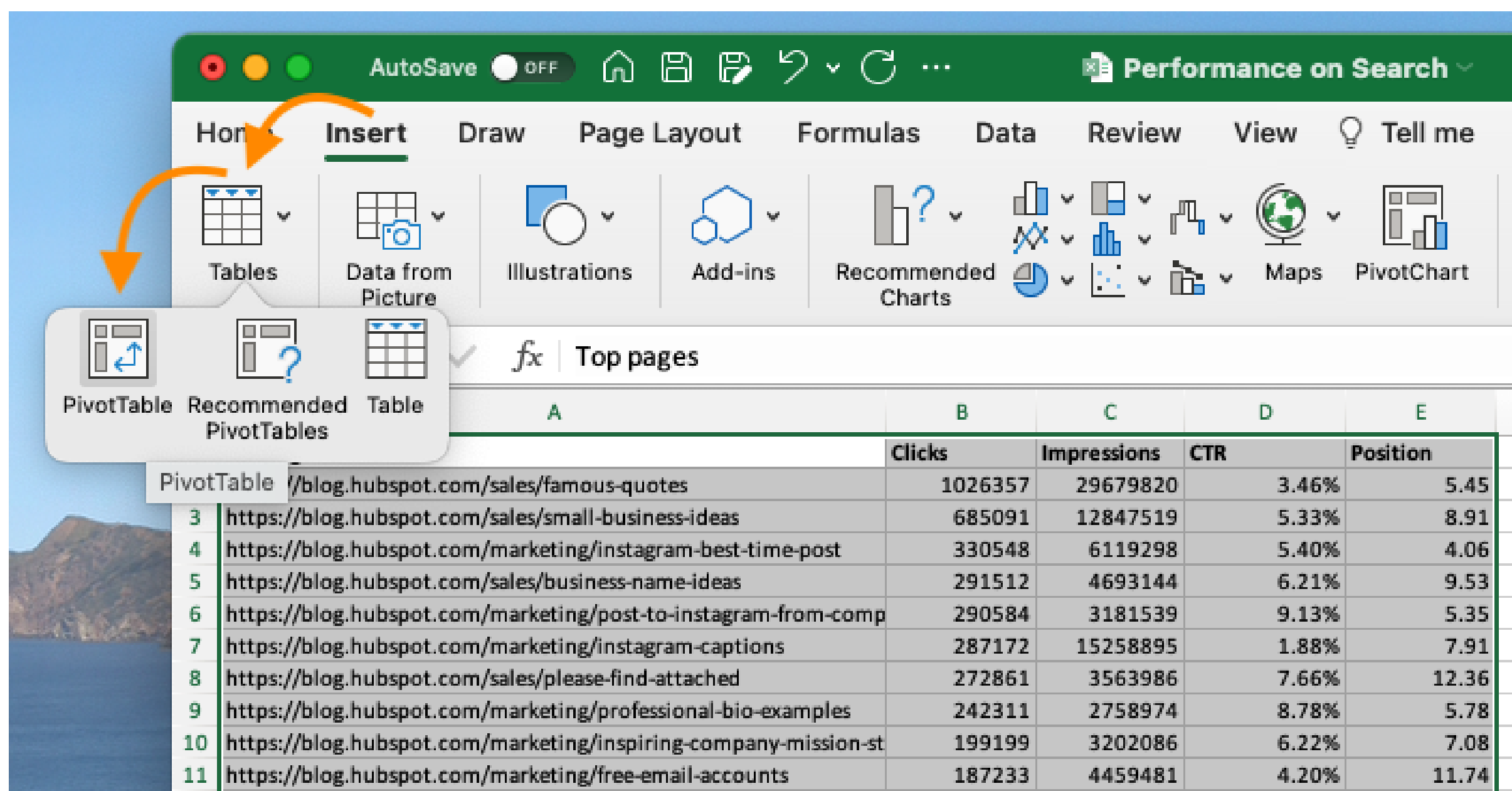


Q1. What are the primary features of Microsoft Excel?

Ans. Excel is known for its versatile functions, including spreadsheet management, data visualization, formula calculations, PivotTables, and macro programming through VBA.

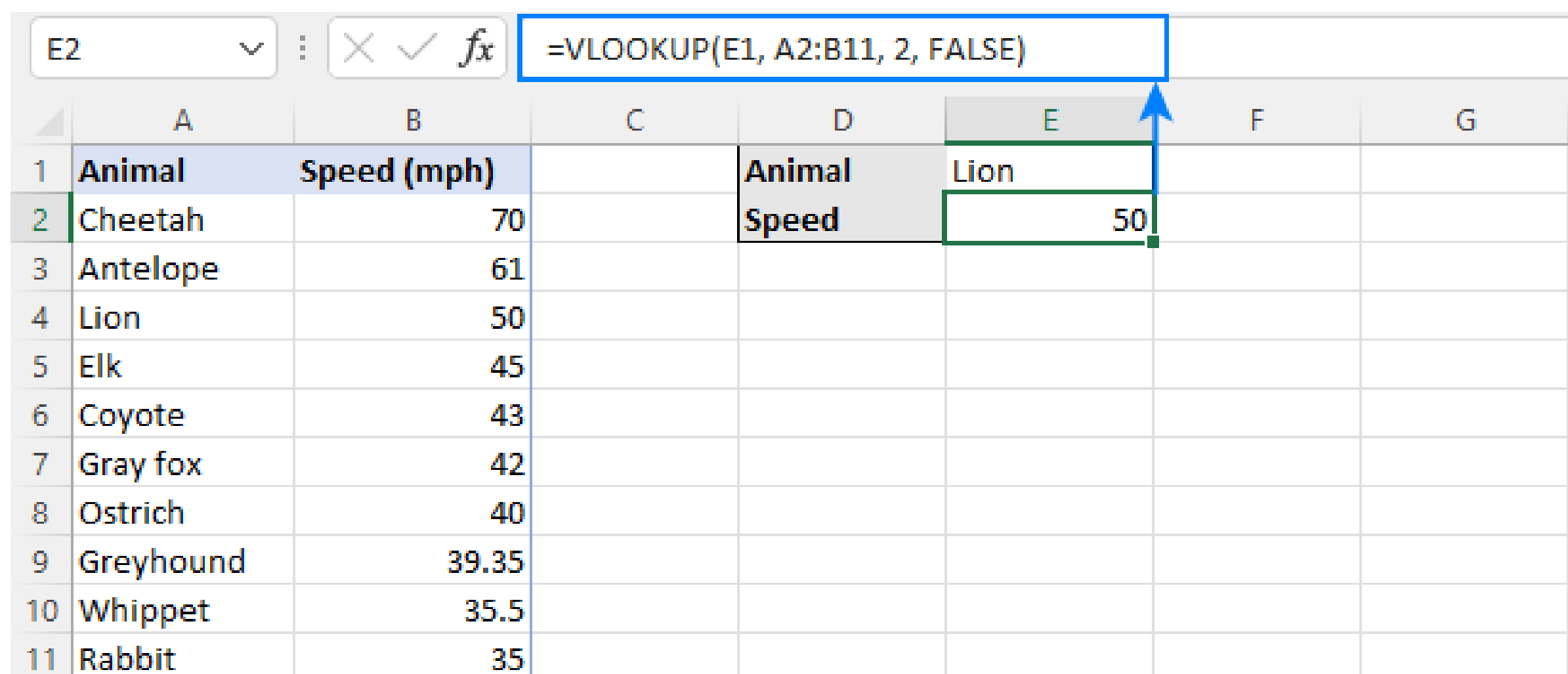
Q2. How do you create a PivotTable?

Ans. Answer: Select your data range, go to the 'Insert' tab, and click on 'PivotTable'. Then, choose the fields for rows, columns, values, and filters.



Q3. Explain VLOOKUP and its limitations.

Ans. VLOOKUP searches for a value in the first column of a range and returns a value in the same row from a specified column. Its limitations include inability to look to the left and requirement for the source data to be sorted.



	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	Animal	Speed (mph)		Animal	Lion		
2	Cheetah	70		Speed	50		
3	Antelope	61					
4	Lion	50					
5	Elk	45					
6	Coyote	43					
7	Gray fox	42					
8	Ostrich	40					
9	Greyhound	39.35					
10	Whippet	35.5					
11	Rabbit	35					

=VLOOKUP(E1, A2:B11, 2, FALSE)

Look up *this value*, in *this range*, return a match from *this column*, search for exact match



Q4. What is the difference between functions and formulas in Excel?

Ans. A formula is an expression written by the user to calculate values, while a function is a predefined calculation in Excel.

Q5. Can you explain the IF function in Excel?

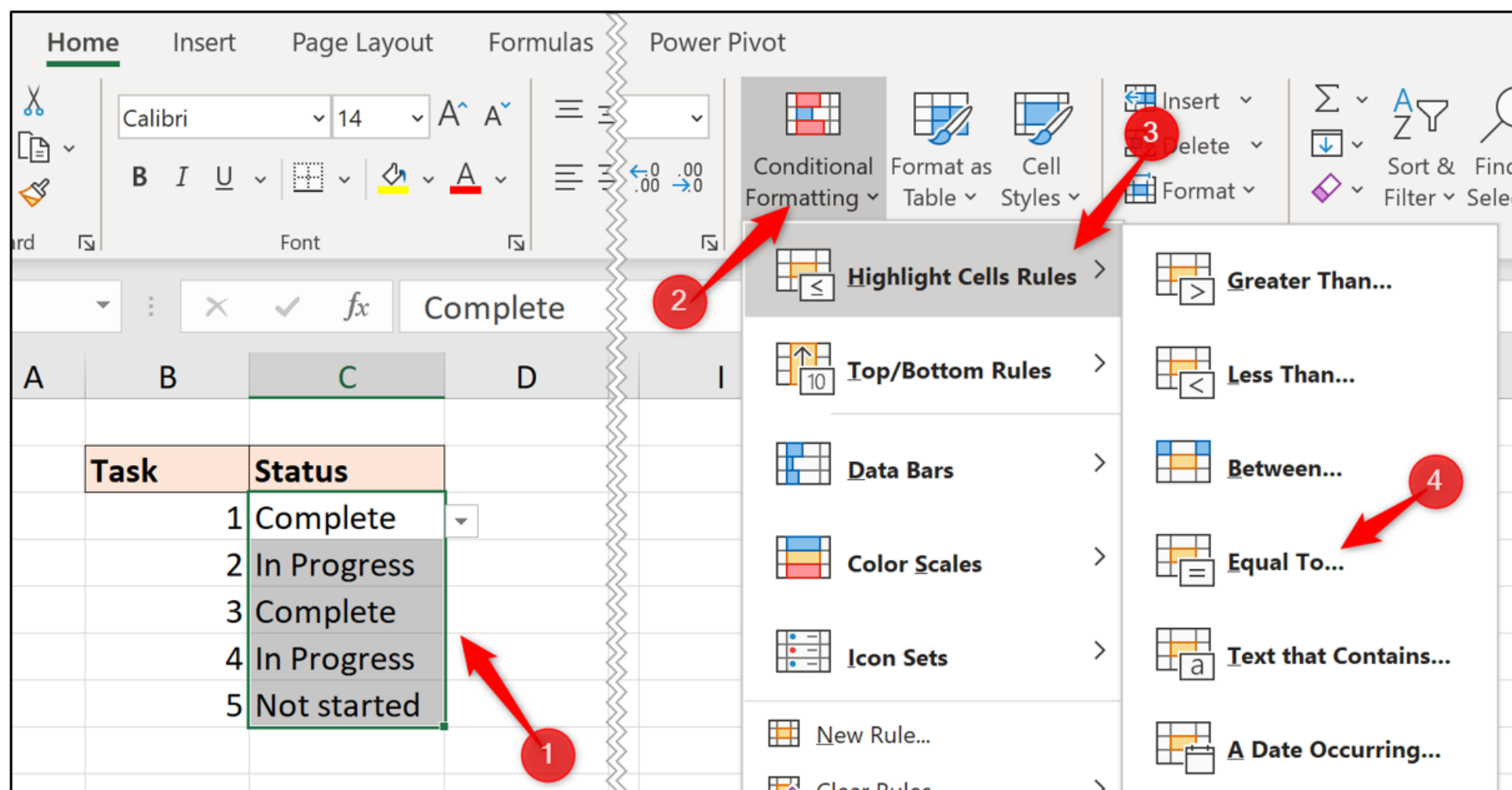
Ans. The IF function performs a logical test and returns one value if the test is true, and another if false.

Syntax: `=IF(logical_test, value_if_true, value_if_false)`

Q6. How do you apply conditional formatting in Excel?

Ans. Select the cells, go to the 'Home' tab, click on 'Conditional Formatting', and set your desired rules.





Q7. Describe a few ways to optimize large Excel files.

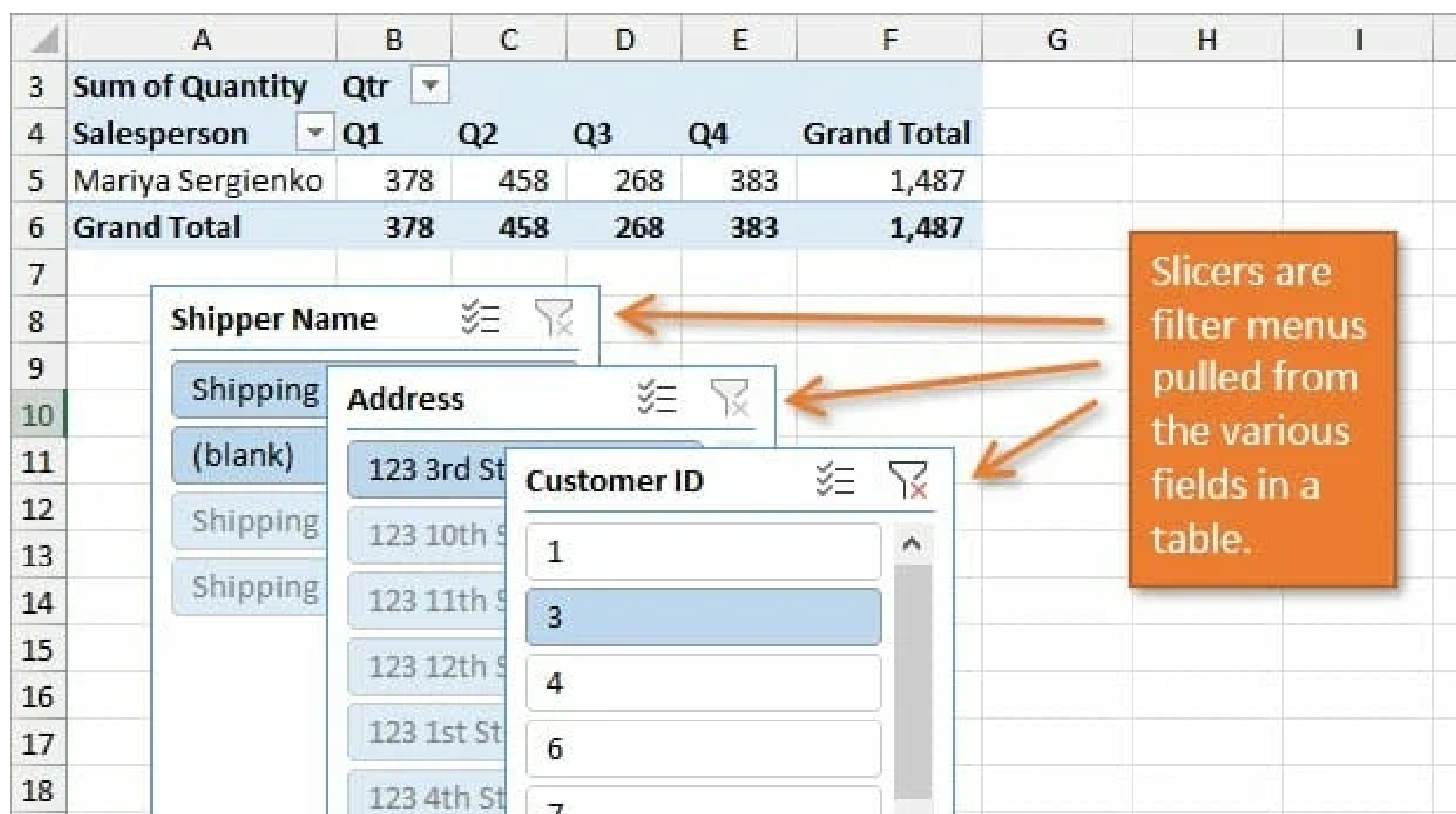
Ans. Use PivotTables, avoid volatile functions like INDIRECT, minimize the use of entire row/column references, and use data validation.

Q8. What are Excel macros and how are they useful?

Ans. Macros are sequences of instructions that automate repetitive tasks. They're written in VBA and can significantly reduce manual effort.

Q9. What is a slicer in Excel?

Ans. Slicers are visual filters used for PivotTables and PivotCharts, allowing for easy filtering of data in an interactive way.



The screenshot shows an Excel PivotTable with the following data:

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
3	Sum of Quantity	Qtr							
4	Salesperson	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Grand Total			
5	Mariya Sergienko	378	458	268	383	1,487			
6	Grand Total	378	458	268	383	1,487			

Three slicers are overlaid on the table:

- Shipper Name**: A list of shipping names with a filter icon.
- Address**: A list of addresses with a filter icon.
- Customer ID**: A list of customer IDs with a filter icon.

An orange text box on the right states: "Slicers are filter menus pulled from the various fields in a table." Arrows point from this box to each of the three slicers.

Q10. Explain the difference between relative, absolute, and mixed cell references.

Ans. Relative references change when a formula is copied, absolute references (\$A\$1) stay constant, and mixed references (A\$1 or \$A1) partially change.

Q11. How do you lock cells in Excel to protect them from editing?

Ans. Select the cells, right-click, choose 'Format Cells', go to the 'Protection' tab, check 'Locked', and then protect the sheet under the 'Review' tab.

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Excel interface with the 'Format Cells' context menu open. The 'Protection' tab is selected, and the 'Locked' checkbox is checked. The worksheet contains a table with agent sales and commissions.

Agent	Sales	Commission
Iona Ford	10,500	788
Paul Tron	23,500	1,763
Camille Orne	22,470	1,685
Kerry Oki	950	71
Pepe Roni	3,500	263
Totals	60,920	4,570

The status bar at the bottom shows: Ready, Average: 12,184, Count: 5, Sum: 60,920, 100%.

Q12. What are Array Formulas and how do you use them?

Ans. Array formulas perform multiple calculations on one or more items in an array and can return either a single result or multiple results.

Q13. How do you use the SUMIF function?

Ans. SUMIF adds up numbers in a range that meet specified criteria.

Syntax: `SUMIF(range, criteria, [sum_range])`

Q14. Describe how you can connect Excel with other data sources.

Ans. Excel can connect to external data sources like SQL databases, web pages, or other spreadsheets through the 'Data' tab.



Excel ribbon showing the **DATA** tab with the **Connections** group highlighted. The **Workbook Connections** task pane is open, showing a list of connections. An orange arrow points from the **Connections** group to the task pane, and another arrow points from the **test** connection to the **Remove** button.

ID	Month	Product	City	Quantity	Amount
2	2 April	Bikes	Montreal	12	4500
3	3 April	Bikes	Montreal	56	21000
4	4 April	Bikes	San Francisco	854	320250
5	5 April	Bikes	New York	25	9375
6	6 April	Skates	Montreal	56	5544
7	7 April	Skates	Toronto	854	84546
8	8 April	Skates	San Francisco	25	2475
9	9 April	Skates	New York	663	65637
10	10 April	Skis Long	Montreal	854	209230
11	11 April	Skis Long	Toronto	25	6125
12	12 April	Skis Long	San Francisco	663	162435
13	13 April	Skis Long	New York	21	5145
14	14 April	Skis Short	Montreal	21	4389
15	15 April	Skis Short	Toronto	4	836
16	16 April	Skis Short	San Francisco	522	109098
17	17 April	Skis Short	New York	136	28424
18	18 April	Snow Board	Montreal	4	1232

Q15. Explain the use of the CONCATENATE function.

Ans. CONCATENATE is used to combine two or more text strings into one string.

Excel spreadsheet showing the use of the CONCATENATE function. The formula bar shows `=CONCATENATE(B3,C3,D3)` in cell E3. The spreadsheet contains two examples of text concatenation.

Text 1	Text 2	Text 3	CONCATENATE
By the	Power of Grayskull...	I Have the Power!	By the Power of Grayskull... I Have the Power!
I have	a bad	feeling about this.	I have a bad feeling about this.

Text 1	Text 2	CONCATENATE
Avengers	Assemble	Avengers Assemble!

Formula for the second example: `=CONCATENATE(B7,CHAR(10),C7,"!")`



Bonus Questions

Basic Data Analysis in Excel:

Q1. How do you import and clean data in Excel?

Exp. Understanding of data import options, use of functions like TRIM, CLEAN, and removing duplicates.

Q2. Can you describe a scenario where you used Excel's VLOOKUP/HLOOKUP functions?

Exp. Practical understanding of lookup functions for data retrieval.

Intermediate Data Analysis Techniques:

Q3. How do you handle large datasets in Excel? Are there any limitations?

Exp. Knowledge about Excel's row/column limits and strategies like data segmentation, use of external data sources.



Q4. Describe a complex formula you have used in Excel for data analysis.

Exp. Proficiency in combining multiple functions and creating nested formulas.

Advanced Data Science Features in Excel:

Q5. How would you use Excel for statistical analysis? Give examples of functions you have used.

Exp. Familiarity with statistical functions like AVERAGE, MEDIAN, STDEV, CORREL, and data analysis toolpak.

Q6. Can Excel be used for predictive analysis? If so, how?

Exp. Knowledge about regression tools, forecast functions, and trend analysis in Excel.

Q7. Discuss how you can integrate Excel with other tools for advanced data science tasks.

Exp. Understanding of Excel's integration capabilities with programming languages like Python, or platforms like Power BI.





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